

Enter The Matrix

All grace and flow

Enter The Matrix is a game that builds a story parallel to the sequence of events in the film *Matrix Reloaded*. It attempts to combine the best parts of *Max Payne* and *Mortal Kombat*, but does not win on all counts.

You can take on the role of Niobe or Ghost—the characters that play supporting roles in the actual movie. The missions vary according to the character you choose, so you can replay the game without being bored. The game has great graphics and sound, and a major portion of the game is based on third person hand-to-hand and armed combat. Both the characters have great attacking moves that are matched by good motion capture and



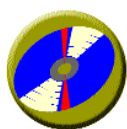
FOCUS! Ghost battles Trinity in the Zen Garden

feedback. The focus mode, which slows the entire world down, looks spectacular and provides for good eye candy. You can eliminate multiple enemies effectively using the Punch-Kick-Block system. There

is an arsenal of weapons in the armed combat system, and they are quite effective as well. The game also features an hour of unseen film footage.

The real problem lies in the Driving and the Logos missions. The driving experience is unreal—you cannot overturn an enemy vehicle or get out of your car, and even the controls are unrealistic. The missions usually involve evading enemies. You have to fly the ship to a specific location, and avoid or destroy the Sentinels before they breach your ship. The controls of the ship are awkward and difficult to adjust to. Overall, the game could have been much better, and focussed more on action.

Distributor: Milestone Interactive Software Ltd ■ **Phone:** 022-28381614 ■ **Web site:** www.milestoneinteractive.com ■ **Price:** Rs 1,499
System requirements: PIII 800 MHz, 128 MB RAM, GeForce 256, 4.3 GB harddisk space, Windows compatible soundcard, DirectX 9.0
Rating: ★★☆☆☆



X2: WOLVERINE'S REVENGE

How much is my score?

Why can't people just stop making games out of comic strip characters? Wasn't Spiderman enough? In *X2: Wolverine's Revenge*, you play the role of Wolverine, a mutant with an unbreakable Adamantium metal skeletal structure, who can heal himself at will. He is infected with a deadly virus called Shiva, and is in search of the cure. The game has a few interesting features; where you can try cool stunts in the hand to hand combat, perform wacky moves and kick enemies using the combos, strike moves and finishing moves. The game has a high level of violence—the Feral mode has Wolverine going into a killing frenzy. Essentially, it is a game to be enjoyed only with a gamepad, the key-



GRRR! - Mommy, how sharp are my nails?

board cannot do it justice.

So, how tough is it to handle modelled graphics and use it to emulate the story of a movie-based game? *X-Men 2: Wolverine's Revenge* finds this to be tough indeed. The game features graphics that would make

Quake 2 look good. The sound effects are not worth mentioning. There are a few notable visual effects, such as the one when Wolverine scrapes the walls with his Claws and during some of the trick shots. The terrains are also poorly designed. The game has the common third person view that is way too irritating and meddling with the game play, due to which movements are hindered. Also, the game features minimal use of pointer devices such as a mouse or trackball, as a majority of the game inputs are based on the keyboard. Hence, the learning curve of this game is also quite high. All in all, you can give *Wolverine's Revenge* a miss, and not bother about this revengeful saga at all.

Publisher: Activision ■ **Distributor:** Milestone Interactive Software Ltd. ■ **Phone:** 022-28381614 ■ **Web site:** www.milestoneinteractive.com
Price: Rs 1,299 ■ **System requirements:** 500 MHz CPU, 128 MB Ram, 32 MB DirectX9 Supported Video card, 1.5 GB hard disk space, CD-Rom drive, Windows 98/ME/2000/XP, DirectX 9 ■ **Rating:** ★★☆☆☆